

Mother's Day

By J. B. Priestley

- Mrs. Pearson is a dedicated wife and mother who tends to each and every demand of her husband George and children Doris and Cyril, both of whom are adults.
- Yet, she is disrespected and taken for granted by them. All the three family members lack gratitude towards her. In fact they treat her like a domestic help.
- Mrs. Pearson shares her grief with her neighbour Mrs. Fitzgerald. Mrs. Fitzgerald tells her that her own soft behavior is responsible for the misgivings of the family members.
- Mrs. Fitzgerald has a plan for her. With the magic that she once learnt in the far east, she suggests that the two of them should exchange their spirits with each other.
- Initially reluctant, Mrs. Pearson agrees to the idea. They both hold hands and their spirits get exchanged when Mrs. Fitzgerald reads a spell.
- Doris is shocked to find her mother smoking when she comes home. She orders her mother to prepare tea. But Mrs. Pearson remains indifferent towards her demand. This sudden change baffles Doris.
- She goes to her room to find that her yellow dress has not

been ironed. She gets really upset and almost scolds her mother for not doing this work.

- Upon hearing her words, Mrs. Pearson replies with disgust that Doris being a grown up should do her work on her own. Also, she makes fun of her friend Charlie Spence and calls him a "half-witted buck tooth".

- Doris feels deeply offended and starts weeping.

- Then her son Cyril comes home and notices Doris crying and mother playing with cards. He too demands tea and snacks but is met with the same indifference from his mother.

- The children discuss their mother's strange behavior when they see her filling a glass of wine for herself.

- Doris hints that perhaps the mother has gone mad owing to some head injury after a fall or so.

- The mother chides them for their callousness and tries to give them a piece of her mind.

- She tells them that she would not work for more than eight hours every day like them from then onwards and will also go for a vacation during weekend.

- She also proclaims that she would do some work on Saturday and Sunday only if she is thanked for everything.

- Her husband George Pearson enters the room and senses tension in the ambience.
- He is annoyed that instead of preparing tea his wife is sipping wine and relaxing. But Mrs. Pearson shows only indifference.
- He then tells her that he would have supper at the club. Mrs. Pearson gets annoyed at his attitude and rebukes him by telling him that people at the club make fun of him behind his back.
- All the family members are feeling miserable. Just then enters Mrs. Fitzgerald (actually Mrs. Pearson).
- Mrs. Pearson (actually Mrs. Fitzgerald) tells her that she was just putting everyone at place and that the things were alright.
- The family members look at each other in confusion when Mrs. Fitzgerald (actually Mrs. Pearson) requests to have their spirits re-exchanged. Mrs. Pearson (actually Mrs. Fitzgerald) agrees on a condition that Mrs. Pearson would not go soft on her family again. They get into their original bodies and Mrs. Fitzgerald leaves.
- The mother, the children and husband smile at each other with relief and it is decided that they all will have the dinner together and play a game of rummy.

- This play provides a glimpse into the miserable lives of house-wives and mothers who work tirelessly from morning to night for keeping their family members happy. Their sacrifices are taken for granted and they are treated as domestic helps. It teaches us to be thoughtful and respectful for our mothers.
- Mrs. Pearson is a dedicated wife and mother who tends to each and every demand of her husband and children, both of whom are adults.
- Yet, she is disrespected and taken for granted by all of them. They lack gratitude towards her, infact they treat her like a servant.
- Mrs. Pearson shares her grief with her neighbour Mrs. Fitzgerald tells her that her own soft behaviour is responsible for the misgivings of her family members.

Main Events

1. The incident with Doris

A. Doris is shocked to find her mother smoking when she comes home. She orders her mother to prepare tea. But Mrs. Pearson remains indifferent towards her demand. This sudden change baffles Doris.

B. She goes to her room to find that her yellow dress has not been ironed. She gets really upset and almost scolds her mother for not doing it.

C. Upon hearing her words, Mrs. Pearson replies with disgust

that Doris being a grown up should do her work on her own. Also, she makes fun of her friend Charlie Spence and calls him a "half-witted buck tooth".

2. Mrs. Pearson Takes Cyril to the Book

Doris feels deeply offended and starts weeping. Then her son Cyril comes home and notices Doris crying and mother playing with cards. He too demands tea and snacks but is met with the same indifference from his mother. Both Cyril and Doris discuss the sudden change in their mother's behavior.

3. Mrs. Pearson Declares her Agenda

The mother chides them for their callousness and tries to give them a piece of her mind. She tells them that she would not work for more than eight hours every day like them from then onwards and will also go for a vacation during the weekend. She also proclaims that she would do some work on Saturday and Sunday only if she is thanked for everything.

4. Mrs. Pearson's Attitude Towards George

He is annoyed that instead of preparing tea his wife is sipping wine and relaxing. But Mrs. Pearson shows only indifference. He then tells her that he would have supper at the club. Mrs. Pearson gets annoyed at his attitude and rebukes him by telling him that people at the club make fun of him behind his back.

5. The Big Change

A. When Mrs. Fitzgerald and Mrs. Pearson exchange their spirits again, the children and husband smile at each other with relief and decide that they will change their selfish attitudes and cooperate with their mother.

B. This play provides a glimpse into the miserable lives of house-wives and mothers who work tirelessly from morning to night to keep their family members happy. Their sacrifices are taken for granted and they are treated as servants. This lesson teaches us to be thoughtful and respectful for our mothers.

